

The SUPERPOWER BRAIN



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John McCarthy explains artificial intelligence (AI) as “the science and engineering of making intelligent machines, particularly intellectual computer programs.”

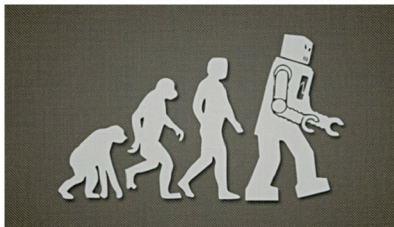
AI is a method to turn a computer into a computer-controlled robot or a software-controlled machine that ‘thinks’ wisely, in a manner similar to the way intelligent human beings think. It is done by studying humans—how they think, study, choose and work while trying to resolve a problem—and then by means of the outcomes of this study, developing appropriate software and systems.

AI combines the characteristics of computer science, physiology and philosophy. It creates a machine that is unnaturally bright by following such programs and equipment that are able to take decisions on their own. Researchers are making systems that can emulate the thoughts of human beings, identify their speech and interact with them.

AI is made up of two words: artificial and intelligence.

Artificial. It is something that is not ordinary, but is made using human skills. It implies creating a replica or simulation of a human brain. Though you can make a machine unnaturally related to human beings, it lacks naturalness and spontaneity.

Fig. 1: Evolution of artificial intelligence



Interesting facts about AI

AI started in 1950. Let us discuss some AI facts that are crucial in today's era.

AI can repair itself. A recently-developed robot can rebuild itself even after trailing two of its six legs. The robot does not know what is broken, but it can notice the performance being dropped. Therefore using an algorithm, it can determine what is wrong and how to amend it.

AI can write. Data that is captured from seismographs is used by a computer to write an article, which then turns it into figures and plugs those figures into a beautiful story. It takes the graphs and compiles these into well-written reports.

Intelligence. This means injecting intelligence into a machine so that it can easily carry out the work that would otherwise need a human brain. The machine can make its own decisions, according to the situation.

How AI originated

The growth of AI started with the desire of introducing intelligence in machines that was similar to the intelligence in human beings. AI has the following two basic goals:

Creating expert systems. Systems that exhibit intelligent behaviour and can study, reveal, describe and advise its users.

Implementing human intelligence in machines. To make systems that comprehend, think, study and act like human beings.

British mathematician Alan Mathison Turing, known as the father of AI, predicted in the early 1950s that, going ahead machines would perform human acts that even human beings would fail to achieve. He devised Turing Test to test a machine's ability to exhibit intelligent behaviour equivalent to, or indistinguishable from, that of a human being.

Real-life applications of AI

AI has an enormous effect on our daily life, and its power is likely to rise in the